WEBSITE REQUIREMENTS & TECHNICAL SPECIFICATIONS

South Sudan International Economic,
Trade and Investment Bureau (SS-IETIB)

Proposed Digital Platform: South Sudan International Economic Gateway

Connecting Markets. Facilitating Investment.
Advancing Economic Cooperation.

Website Type	Institutional website and international trade & investment promotion platform
Organization Type	Independent, private, non-governmental and non-profit organization
Initial Languages	English and Simplified Chinese
Geographic Scope	South Sudan, Africa, China, Asia, the Middle East, Europe and other international markets
Document Status	Draft for review and approval

Prepared for SS-IETIB — for website design, development, implementation, testing and maintenance.

1. PROJECT OVERVIEW

1.1 Background

The South Sudan International Economic, Trade and Investment Bureau (SS-IETIB) is an independent, private, non-governmental and non-profit organization committed to promoting international trade, investment, commercial partnerships and economic cooperation involving South Sudan.

The Bureau seeks to establish a professional digital platform connecting South Sudanese enterprises, international investors, exporters, importers, manufacturers, financial institutions, business associations, development partners and other economic stakeholders.

The website will serve as the Bureau's primary digital presence and a gateway through which international businesses can discover commercial opportunities, learn about South Sudan's economic environment, explore investment prospects, identify potential partners and engage with the Bureau.

Although the platform may initially prioritize business engagement with China, it must be designed for international use and remain open to partners from all countries.

1.2 Project Vision

To establish a credible, modern and internationally accessible digital platform that facilitates business connections, promotes responsible investment and strengthens commercial cooperation involving South Sudan.

1.3 Project Objectives

1. Establish a professional online identity for SS-IETIB.
2. Communicate the Bureau's mandate, objectives, activities and independent institutional status.
3. Promote trade and investment opportunities involving South Sudan.
4. Connect international investors with South Sudanese businesses and project proponents.
5. Support business-to-business introductions and commercial matchmaking.
6. Promote South Sudanese products and services in international markets.
7. Facilitate trade missions, investment forums, conferences and business events.
8. Publish market intelligence, economic information, research and investment guides.
9. Develop an international business directory.
10. Provide a central platform for inquiries, partnership proposals and business registration.
11. Encourage responsible investment and transparent business engagement.
12. Support cooperation with private-sector organizations, professional associations, development partners and relevant public institutions, subject to appropriate permissions and agreements.

2. INSTITUTIONAL IDENTITY AND LEGAL POSITIONING

This section is mandatory and must be considered during design, content development and implementation.

2.1 Official Name

South Sudan International Economic, Trade and Investment Bureau
Official Abbreviation: SS-IETIB

The full name should appear prominently on the homepage, About Us page, website footer and relevant official communications.

2.2 Institutional Description

The South Sudan International Economic, Trade and Investment Bureau (SS-IETIB) is an independent, private, non-governmental and non-profit organization dedicated to promoting international trade, investment, business partnerships and economic cooperation involving South Sudan. Through business networking, investment promotion, market intelligence, trade missions and institutional collaboration, the Bureau works to connect South Sudanese enterprises and economic stakeholders with international businesses, investors and development partners.

This wording may be refined to reflect the organization’s registration documents and approved constitution.

2.3 Legal Status Disclaimer

Institutional Status and Independence
The South Sudan International Economic, Trade and Investment Bureau (SS-IETIB) is an independent, private, non-governmental and non-profit organization.

The Bureau is not a ministry, government department, statutory commission, diplomatic mission, regulatory authority or public agency of the Republic of South Sudan or any other country.

SS-IETIB undertakes trade and investment promotion, business networking, research, facilitation and institutional cooperation within the scope of its lawful mandate. It may engage with government institutions and other organizations where appropriate, subject to applicable laws, permissions and agreements.

Unless expressly authorized in writing by the relevant competent authority, SS-IETIB does not represent any government, exercise public authority, issue government approvals, grant licenses, provide official diplomatic representation or make binding commitments on behalf of any public institution.

Information published on this website is provided for general informational and business facilitation purposes. The Bureau does not guarantee investment returns, project performance, commercial outcomes or the accuracy of third-party claims. Users should conduct independent due diligence and obtain appropriate professional advice before entering into commercial or investment transactions.

The final wording should be reviewed against the Bureau’s registration documents and applicable laws before publication.

2.4 Branding and Visual Identity Rules

- Use the approved SS-IETIB logo and brand identity.
- Present the Bureau as an independent international economic organization.
- Avoid government seals, official insignia, flags incorporated into logos, or institutional emblems that could imply public authority without appropriate permission.
- Avoid descriptions such as “official government investment authority” or “government-appointed commission” unless legally authorized and factually accurate.
- Avoid claims that the Bureau can approve investments, issue licenses, guarantee projects or grant special government privileges.
- Use the names and logos of partner organizations only with appropriate authorization.
- Distinguish confirmed institutional partnerships from prospective relationships.
- Clearly identify any third-party projects, commercial offers or promotional materials.

The design may use professional colors inspired by South Sudan’s national identity, provided the overall branding does not misrepresent the Bureau’s legal status.

3. PROPOSED WEBSITE NAME AND BRANDING

3.1 Institutional Brand

South Sudan International Economic, Trade and Investment Bureau (SS-IETIB)

3.2 Proposed Digital Platform Name

South Sudan International Economic Gateway

This name may be used as the descriptive identity of the Bureau’s online trade and investment platform. It must not be presented as a separate government institution.

3.3 Recommended Tagline

Connecting Markets. Facilitating Investment. Advancing Economic Cooperation.

Alternative tagline: Connecting South Sudan to Global Business Opportunities.

3.4 Brand Personality

- Professionalism
- International credibility
- Independence
- Transparency
- Commercial opportunity
- Responsible investment
- Inclusiveness
- Practical business support
- Long-term economic cooperation

4. TARGET AUDIENCE

- International investors: Individuals, investment groups, companies, family offices and institutional investors exploring opportunities involving South Sudan.
- Importers and exporters: Businesses seeking to source South Sudanese products, export goods into South Sudan or establish cross-border supply relationships.
- South Sudanese businesses: Local enterprises seeking foreign buyers, suppliers, investors, distributors, technology providers and strategic partners.
- Manufacturers and industrial companies: Companies exploring production, processing, infrastructure-related supply chains, industrial partnerships or local commercial opportunities.
- Financial and professional service providers: Banks, financial institutions, consultants, legal professionals, accountants, insurers and business advisory firms.
- Chambers of commerce and business associations: Organizations interested in trade delegations, networking, joint events and private-sector cooperation.
- Development partners and international organizations: Organizations exploring private-sector development, entrepreneurship, capacity building, responsible investment and economic cooperation.
- Government and public institutions: Relevant institutions that may participate in lawful consultations, public-private dialogue, trade promotion activities or approved cooperation initiatives.
- Media and researchers: Journalists, analysts, researchers, academics and other users seeking reliable information about the Bureau and its activities.

5. WEBSITE STRUCTURE AND NAVIGATION

5.1 Main Navigation

1. Home
2. About Us
3. Trade & Exports
4. Invest in South Sudan
5. Business Network
6. International Cooperation
7. Events & Trade Missions
8. Research & Publications
9. News & Updates
10. Contact Us

A prominent language selector shall display: English | □□. The website should be structured so that additional languages can be added in the future.

5.2 Footer Navigation

- About SS-IETIB
- Our Mandate
- Institutional Identity & Legal Status
- Trade & Investment Opportunities
- Business Network
- Events
- Research & Publications
- News
- Contact Information
- Privacy Policy
- Website Terms of Use
- Disclaimer
- Accessibility Statement
- Social Media Links

The footer should also display the official organization name and a copyright notice.

6. HOMEPAGE REQUIREMENTS

6.1 Hero Section

SOUTH SUDAN INTERNATIONAL ECONOMIC, TRADE AND INVESTMENT BUREAU
Connecting Markets. Facilitating Investment. Advancing Economic Cooperation.
Opening South Sudan to Global Business Opportunities

The South Sudan International Economic, Trade and Investment Bureau (SS-IETIB) is an independent, private, non-governmental and non-profit organization committed to promoting international trade, investment, business partnerships and economic cooperation involving South Sudan.

Through business networking, investment promotion, trade missions, market intelligence and institutional collaboration, the Bureau connects South Sudanese enterprises and economic stakeholders with international investors, businesses and development partners.

Our goal is to facilitate meaningful commercial relationships, promote South Sudanese products and services, encourage responsible investment and contribute to sustainable economic development.

Primary buttons: Explore Investment Opportunities • Join Our Business Network • Partner with SS-IETIB

6.2 Key Service Highlights

- Trade and Export Promotion
- Investment Opportunity Facilitation
- International Business Partnerships
- Trade Missions and Economic Events
- Research and Market Intelligence
- Institutional and Private-Sector Cooperation

Each card should include a short description and a link to the relevant section.

6.3 Featured Opportunities

Display selected, verified business or investment opportunities. Each listing should contain, where applicable:

- Opportunity title
- Sector
- Location
- Opportunity description
- Project stage
- Indicative investment range, if verified and approved for publication
- Project proponent
- Supporting documentation, where authorized
- Date published
- Date last reviewed
- Inquiry button

The website must distinguish between opportunities submitted by third parties and opportunities independently verified by SS-IETIB. Do not publish fabricated projects, invented investment figures or unsupported claims about project readiness.

6.4 Featured Events

Display upcoming business forums, trade exhibitions, investor meetings, trade missions, conferences, B2B networking sessions, webinars and private-sector roundtables. Only confirmed events should be labelled as confirmed. Proposed events must be identified as planned or proposed.

6.5 News and Insights

Display recent publications, announcements, business updates, research summaries and event reports.

6.6 Partnership Section

Invite businesses, investors, business associations and institutions to explore cooperation with SS-IETIB.

6.7 Contact and Newsletter Section

Include a contact call to action and an optional newsletter subscription form. Newsletter subscriptions must require appropriate consent and provide a clear unsubscribe mechanism.

7. ABOUT US SECTION

7.1 Who We Are

Explain the Bureau’s identity, purpose, independence and role in international economic cooperation.

7.2 Vision

To become a credible international platform connecting South Sudan with global markets, investment partners and opportunities for sustainable economic development.

7.3 Mission

To facilitate trade, investment promotion, business partnerships, economic research and international cooperation involving South Sudan through professional networking, information sharing and responsible business facilitation.

7.4 Objects and Mandate

Present the Bureau’s approved objects and mandate based on its governing and registration documents. Organize them into the following themes:

- International trade promotion
- Export development and market access
- Investment promotion and project facilitation
- Business matchmaking and networking
- Trade missions and investment events
- Economic research and market intelligence
- Private-sector development
- Institutional partnerships
- Responsible investment and sustainable development
- Public-private dialogue and economic cooperation

The published mandate must not exceed the authority granted by the organization’s governing documents or applicable law.

7.5 Institutional Identity and Legal Status

Publish the legal-status statement described in Section 2.

7.6 Governance and Leadership

Where approved by the organization, this page may display board members, executive leadership, senior management, advisory members, department heads and organizational structure. Do not invent qualifications, appointments, titles or affiliations. Personal information and photographs must be published with appropriate authorization.

7.7 Our Approach

- Professional integrity
- Transparency
- Responsible investment
- Respect for applicable law
- Confidentiality in business introductions
- Fair and inclusive commercial engagement
- Evidence-based information
- Clear separation between facilitation and official regulatory approval

8. TRADE AND EXPORT PROMOTION

8.1 Main Functions

- Promote South Sudanese products and services.
- Help international buyers identify potential suppliers.
- Support export readiness and market development.
- Facilitate introductions between buyers and sellers.
- Publish general trade information and market insights.
- Promote trade exhibitions and commercial delegations.
- Encourage partnerships between local producers and international distributors.

8.2 Product and Service Categories

- Agricultural products
- Food and agro-processing
- Livestock and related products
- Natural resources and minerals
- Energy-related opportunities
- Construction materials
- Consumer goods
- Manufacturing
- Logistics and transport
- Professional services
- Information and communication technology
- Other approved commercial sectors

Listing a sector does not imply that every activity within it is legal, licensed, available or suitable for investment. Applicable legal and regulatory requirements must be considered.

8.3 Supplier and Buyer Inquiry Forms

Forms should collect relevant business information, including company name, country, business sector, contact person, business email, optional telephone number, products or services of interest, type of inquiry, preferred markets, additional information and consent to the privacy notice. Include spam protection and validation.

9. INVEST IN SOUTH SUDAN

9.1 Investment Overview

Provide an introductory overview of South Sudan’s economic environment using appropriately sourced information. Explain that investment decisions require independent due diligence and may be affected by legal, financial, political, security, infrastructure, currency and operational risks.

9.2 Investment Sectors

- Agriculture and agribusiness
- Food processing
- Livestock and related industries
- Energy
- Infrastructure and construction
- Transport and logistics
- Telecommunications and digital services

- Manufacturing
- Tourism and hospitality
- Healthcare-related commercial opportunities
- Education and skills development
- Other lawful and commercially viable sectors

Sector pages must describe opportunities responsibly and avoid presenting speculative projects as approved or operational.

9.3 Investment Opportunity Database

The system should allow authorized administrators to create, update, approve, publish, archive and remove opportunity listings.

Field	Requirement
Opportunity ID	Unique reference number
Title / Sector	Required
Location	Required where known
Description	Required
Project proponent	Required for internal records
Public proponent details	Publish only when authorized
Project stage	Proposed, under development, operational or other defined status
Estimated investment	Optional and supported by a stated source
Funding sought	Optional
Supporting documents	Subject to access permissions
Verification status	Internal administrative field
Publication / review dates	Automatically recorded
Contact or inquiry route	Required
Status	Draft, pending review, published, suspended or archived

The system must support internal review before publication. A verification label must describe the actual checks completed. It must not imply government approval, financial auditing, legal certification or guaranteed project viability unless the relevant verification has genuinely occurred and its scope is clearly explained.

9.4 Investment Inquiry Form

- Name
- Company or organization
- Country of registration
- Business email
- Area of interest
- Indicative investment capacity, optional
- Type of investment or partnership sought
- Relevant opportunity ID, where applicable
- Message
- Preferred contact method
- Privacy acknowledgement

Sensitive financial documents and identity documents should not be requested through a basic public form unless there is a clear need and appropriate security measures are in place.

9.5 Investment Disclaimer

SS-IETIB facilitates access to information, business introductions and potential investment opportunities. The Bureau does not itself grant government approvals, issue licenses or guarantee investment returns, project completion or commercial success. Investors are responsible for conducting appropriate legal, financial, technical, environmental and commercial due diligence and for obtaining all required approvals from competent authorities.

10. INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS NETWORK

10.1 Purpose

Create a structured directory of businesses and organizations interested in trade, investment and commercial cooperation involving South Sudan.

10.2 Directory Categories

- Importers
- Exporters
- Manufacturers
- Distributors
- Investors
- Project proponents
- Service providers
- Logistics companies
- Business associations
- Chambers of commerce
- Professional advisers
- Technology companies
- Development and business-support organizations

10.3 Business Registration Form

- Company or organization name
- Country of registration
- Business address, if required
- Website
- Business email
- Contact person
- Business sector
- Business description
- Products and services
- Countries of interest
- Partnership interests
- Registration or incorporation information, where justified
- Supporting documents, if necessary
- Consent to applicable privacy terms

Distinguish required fields from optional fields.

10.4 Business Directory Profiles

- Organization name
- Country
- Sector
- Products and services
- Website
- Public business contact details
- Partnership interests
- Verification status, if supported by documented checks

Private documents, internal notes and confidential contact information must never be exposed through public directory pages.

10.5 Business Approval Workflow

1. Submission by a business.
2. Automatic acknowledgement.
3. Administrative review.
4. Request for additional information, where necessary.
5. Approval, rejection or return for correction.
6. Publication of approved public information.
7. Periodic review and updating.
8. Suspension or removal when necessary.

Directory membership must not be described as a government license, official endorsement, financial guarantee or certification of commercial performance.

11. INTERNATIONAL COOPERATION AND PARTNERSHIPS

11.1 Potential Cooperation Areas

- Business-to-business partnerships
- Trade promotion
- Joint business forums
- Investment networking
- Commercial research
- Private-sector capacity building
- Enterprise development
- Market access
- Responsible investment
- Economic dialogue
- Institutional cooperation
- Cross-border commercial relationships

11.2 Partner Categories

- Chambers of commerce
- Business associations
- Private companies
- Industry groups
- Universities and research institutions

- Professional associations
- Development organizations
- Financial institutions
- Relevant public institutions

A prospective partner must not be described as an existing partner until the relationship has been confirmed and permission to publish the relationship has been obtained where necessary.

11.3 Partnership Proposal Form

- Organization name
- Country
- Contact person
- Organization type
- Proposed cooperation area
- Summary of the proposal
- Expected outcomes
- Relevant experience
- Supporting documents
- Preferred next steps
- Consent to the privacy notice

Acceptance of a proposal must not automatically be treated as a formal agreement.

12. EVENTS, TRADE MISSIONS AND BUSINESS FORUMS

12.1 Event Categories

- Trade missions
- Investment forums
- Business conferences
- Trade exhibitions
- B2B meetings
- Networking sessions
- Webinars
- Business delegations
- Private-sector roundtables

12.2 Event Pages

- Event title
- Date and time
- Time zone
- Venue or online meeting format
- Description
- Organizer
- Confirmed partners, where applicable
- Agenda
- Speakers, where confirmed
- Registration form
- Participation terms
- Contact information

- Event status
- Cancellation or change notices

12.3 Event Registration

The system should record registrations and provide automatic acknowledgements. Administrators should be able to export attendee lists securely and send approved event communications. Registration must not imply a guarantee of a visa, entry permission, investment approval or admission to a third-party event.

13. RESEARCH AND MARKET INTELLIGENCE

13.1 Publication Categories

- Market research
- Trade insights
- Sector profiles
- Investment guides
- Business environment reports
- Economic analysis
- Trade statistics
- Export guidance
- Country and market briefings
- Event reports
- Business opportunities reports
- Policy and regulatory information summaries

13.2 Publication Features

- Publication title
- Summary
- Author or issuing organization
- Publication date
- Last updated date
- Source references
- Related sectors
- Downloadable documents
- Search and filtering
- Language selection
- Archive

Where possible, publish accessible web content rather than exclusively PDF documents.

13.3 Research Standards

- Cite credible sources.
- Clearly distinguish fact from opinion.
- Identify estimates and assumptions.
- Record publication and revision dates.
- Correct significant errors.
- Avoid unsupported economic or investment claims.
- Identify third-party content.
- Explain important limitations in the data.

14. NEWS AND MEDIA

The News section should support publication of Bureau announcements, trade and investment updates, business success stories, partnership announcements, event reports, research releases, international cooperation updates and media statements.

Each item should include a publication date, author or issuing office where appropriate, category and language version. Administrators must be able to edit, unpublish or archive articles. Press releases and official statements must be approved by an authorized representative before publication.

15. CONTACT US

15.1 Contact Information

The page should contain approved details for general inquiries, trade inquiries, investment inquiries, business network registration, partnership proposals, events and delegations, media inquiries and administrative matters.

The organization’s physical address, telephone numbers, email addresses and office hours must be confirmed before launch. No unverified contact information should be published.

15.2 General Inquiry Form

- Name
- Organization
- Country
- Email
- Subject
- Inquiry category
- Message
- Privacy acknowledgement

15.3 Contact Management

Route inquiries to designated organizational email addresses or a secure administrative interface. Record submission time, category, status and assigned administrator. Restrict access to authorized personnel.

16. ENGLISH AND CHINESE LANGUAGE SUPPORT

16.1 Language Requirements

The website must launch in English and Simplified Chinese. The language selector should be visible in the main navigation and mobile menu.

Provide separate language versions of the core pages: Home; About Us; Objects and Mandate; Institutional Identity and Legal Status; Trade and Exports; Investment Opportunities; Business Network; International Cooperation; Events; Research and Publications; News; Contact; Privacy Policy; Terms of Use; and Disclaimer.

16.2 Translation Requirements

- Use professional translation or qualified human review.
- Ensure Chinese communicates the same legal status and limitations as English.
- Translate form labels, error messages, buttons, menus and confirmation messages.
- Allow administrators to manage each language independently.
- Identify untranslated pages clearly.

- Preserve names, dates, figures and project details accurately.
- Use Chinese-compatible fonts and suitable typography.

16.3 Technical Requirements

- Correct language metadata
- Separate, stable URLs for each language
- Language-aware navigation
- Language-specific search metadata
- Appropriate multilingual SEO annotations
- Correct character encoding
- Language-specific content management

Additional languages, such as Arabic or French, may be added in future phases.

17. DESIGN AND USER EXPERIENCE

17.1 Overall Design

Use a modern, professional, clean and internationally credible design. The website should resemble a high-quality international trade and investment organization’s website rather than a government portal or generic commercial landing page.

17.2 Visual Elements

- Professional institutional logo
- High-quality images of South Sudanese business activity
- Commercial and industrial photography
- Agriculture and production imagery
- International trade and logistics imagery
- Business meetings and networking photography
- Clean typography
- Clear navigation
- Consistent iconography
- Structured information cards
- Readable charts and infographics where appropriate

Images must be properly licensed or otherwise authorized for use.

17.3 Color Palette

The designer should propose a restrained institutional palette, potentially incorporating deep navy blue, white, gold or muted amber, dark charcoal and carefully selected accent colors. SS-IETIB should approve the final palette.

17.4 Mobile-First Design

The website must function properly on smartphones, tablets, laptops, desktop computers and large displays. Navigation, forms, tables, images and directory listings must adapt to smaller screens.

17.5 Accessibility

Target WCAG 2.2 Level AA as the accessibility benchmark. Requirements include:

- Keyboard navigation and visible focus indicators
- Appropriate color contrast
- Meaningful image alternative text
- Proper heading structure

- Accessible form labels
- Clear validation and error messages
- Captions or transcripts for relevant multimedia
- Screen-reader-compatible components
- Scalable text
- Accessible documents wherever practicable

Accessibility should be tested during development and before launch. The website should publish an accessibility statement that accurately reflects its actual conformance.

18. CONTENT MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

18.1 CMS Functions

- Create and edit pages
- Publish and unpublish content
- Manage English and Chinese versions
- Publish news articles
- Upload approved documents
- Manage events
- Manage business directory submissions
- Review investment opportunities
- Moderate submitted content
- Respond to inquiries
- Update contact information
- Manage images and media
- View basic website analytics
- Manage user accounts and permissions
- Maintain content revision history where supported

18.2 User Roles

Role	Permissions
Super Administrator	Full technical and administrative control
Website Administrator	General website and content management
Content Editor	Draft and edit assigned content
Publisher	Review and publish approved content
Investment Officer	Manage investment opportunities
Business Network Officer	Review business directory submissions
Events Officer	Manage events and registrations
Research Editor	Manage publications and research
Inquiry Officer	Access and manage assigned inquiries

Roles may be adjusted to match SS-IETIB’s staffing arrangements.

18.3 Approval Workflow

Draft → Review → Approval → Publication → Periodic Review → Archive

Sensitive announcements, partnership statements, investment listings and legal information should require approval from an authorized person.

19. TECHNICAL ARCHITECTURE

19.1 Platform Requirements

- Responsive design
- Bilingual content
- Secure administration
- Structured databases
- Forms and notifications
- Search and filtering
- Business directory functionality
- Investment opportunity management
- Event registration
- Search-engine optimization
- Analytics
- Regular backups
- Future expansion
- Integration with appropriate third-party services

A reputable CMS-based solution may be suitable for Phase 1, provided it can support future features without requiring an unnecessary rebuild.

19.2 Domain Name

The developer should recommend and check the availability of suitable domain names before purchase. Naming directions may be based on the SS-IETIB abbreviation, the full institutional name or the South Sudan International Economic Gateway concept. No domain should be assumed available until verified. SS-IETIB should retain ownership and administrative control of its domain registration.

19.3 Hosting

- Reliable uptime
- HTTPS support
- Regular backups
- Security monitoring
- Adequate storage and bandwidth
- Server-side logging
- Restore capability
- Technical support
- Room for future growth

Choose hosting after considering performance, cost, applicable data protection requirements and operational needs.

19.4 Performance

- Compress and appropriately size images.
- Minimize unnecessary scripts.
- Use browser caching where suitable.
- Optimize page rendering.
- Avoid unnecessary animation.

- Monitor Core Web Vitals.
- Test important pages on mobile devices and slower connections.

Performance targets should be agreed during development and measured before launch.

19.5 Search Functionality

Provide search across relevant published content. Future directory and investment search should support filters such as sector, country, opportunity type, location, project stage, business category and publication date. Search results must exclude unpublished, restricted or confidential records.

20. SECURITY REQUIREMENTS

20.1 Minimum Security Controls

- HTTPS across the website
- Secure administrator authentication
- Multi-factor authentication for privileged accounts where supported
- Role-based access control
- Strong password and session management
- Regular software and dependency updates
- Protection against common web vulnerabilities
- Input validation and output encoding
- Spam and automated-submission protection
- Secure file-upload handling
- Restricted administrative access where practical
- Regular backups
- Documented recovery procedures
- Security logging and incident response procedures

20.2 Data Protection

- Privacy notice
- Defined purposes for data collection
- Appropriate retention and deletion procedures
- Restricted access to personal data
- Secure inquiry handling
- Appropriate cookie controls where required
- Clear newsletter consent and unsubscribe functionality
- Process for handling privacy requests and incidents

Applicable data protection obligations must be reviewed in light of the countries where SS-IETIB operates, user locations and the services it provides.

20.3 Confidentiality

Information submitted for private business introductions, investment discussions or partnership proposals must not be displayed publicly without authorization. Public directory records must be separated from internal administrative records.

Explain that submitting an inquiry does not automatically create a legally privileged or confidential relationship. Where confidentiality is required, establish appropriate agreements and secure procedures.

20.4 Backups and Recovery

The developer must propose backup frequency, retention period, secure backup storage, recovery procedures and recovery testing. A recovery test must be completed before launch or as part of the agreed handover.

21. SEARCH ENGINE OPTIMIZATION AND DIGITAL VISIBILITY

21.1 SEO Requirements

- Search-friendly page URLs
- Unique page titles
- Relevant meta descriptions
- Proper heading structure
- Descriptive image alternative text
- XML sitemap
- Robots directives
- Canonical URLs where appropriate
- Language-specific SEO metadata
- Multilingual search-engine annotations
- Structured data where suitable
- Fast page loading
- Social sharing previews

21.2 Content Strategy

- Trade opportunities involving South Sudan
- South Sudan investment information
- South Sudanese products and exporters
- International business partnerships
- Trade missions and investor events
- Market research
- Sector profiles
- Business networking opportunities
- Economic cooperation

Published information must remain accurate, dated and appropriately sourced.

21.3 Analytics

Support privacy-conscious analytics to monitor visitor numbers, popular pages, aggregate visitor geography, referral sources, search performance, form submissions, event registrations, business directory registrations and investment inquiries. Restrict analytics access to authorized personnel.

22. SOCIAL MEDIA AND COMMUNICATION CHANNELS

Include links to approved social media accounts. Potential channels may include LinkedIn, Facebook, YouTube and other platforms selected by SS-IETIB. Provide social sharing metadata, consistent branding, links to official accounts, a news subscription facility and contact/inquiry pathways. Do not link to accounts that have not been confirmed as controlled or authorized by SS-IETIB.

23. ADMINISTRATIVE DASHBOARD AND FUTURE PORTAL

23.1 Phase 1 Dashboard

- Page and news management
- Publication management
- Event management
- Inquiry management
- User permissions
- Basic analytics
- English and Chinese content management

23.2 Future Portal Functions

- Business member accounts
- Company profile management
- Investment project submission
- Investor accounts
- Advanced opportunity search
- Business-to-business matchmaking
- Meeting requests
- Secure document exchange
- Event booking and payment, if required
- Automated email notifications
- Member dashboards
- Project pipeline management
- Additional language versions
- Integration with approved third-party services

These features are not included in the initial website contract unless explicitly listed in the agreed scope.

24. WEBSITE DEVELOPMENT PHASES

Phase 1: Institutional Website

Objective: Establish the Bureau’s official digital presence.

- Homepage
- About Us
- Vision and Mission
- Objects and Mandate
- Institutional Identity and Legal Status
- Trade and Exports
- Invest in South Sudan
- International Cooperation
- Business Network overview
- Events and Trade Missions
- Research and Publications
- News and Updates

- Contact Us
- English and Simplified Chinese support
- CMS and administrative dashboard
- Inquiry forms
- Privacy Policy and Terms of Use
- Website Disclaimer
- Accessibility Statement
- Basic SEO setup
- Security configuration
- Analytics configuration
- Backup and recovery procedures
- Testing, deployment and handover

Recommended priority: Complete Phase 1 before investing in more complex portal features.

Phase 2: Business and Investment Portal

Objective: Introduce structured commercial information and registration functions.

- Investment opportunity database
- Business directory
- Business registration workflow
- Investment inquiry management
- Advanced sector and opportunity filtering
- Event registration system
- Newsletter management
- Enhanced administrative reporting
- Business and investor inquiry tracking
- Publication and document library improvements

Phase 3: International Economic Gateway

Objective: Develop the website into a more advanced international business facilitation platform.

- Business member accounts
- Investor dashboards
- Company profile management
- Business matchmaking
- B2B meeting requests
- Secure document exchange
- Automated matching recommendations
- Expanded multilingual support
- Advanced reporting and analytics
- Approved external system integrations

Phase 3 should proceed only after assessing user demand, operating capacity, budget and legal and security implications.

25. PROJECT DELIVERABLES

25.1 Design Deliverables

- Initial design concepts
- Approved color palette and typography

- Logo integration
- Desktop page designs
- Mobile page designs
- Navigation and sitemap
- English-language layouts
- Chinese-language layouts

25.2 Development Deliverables

- Fully developed website
- Responsive layouts
- CMS configuration
- Database configuration where required
- Working inquiry forms
- Language-switching functionality
- Approved page content
- Security configuration
- SEO configuration
- Analytics integration
- Backup configuration

25.3 Documentation

- Website administration manual
- Content publishing instructions
- User management instructions
- Backup and recovery instructions
- Technical architecture summary
- Software and dependency inventory
- Security and maintenance recommendations
- Domain and hosting details
- List of paid subscriptions and renewal dates

25.4 Ownership and Handover

SS-IETIB should retain ownership or clearly documented contractual rights to its domain name, approved brand assets, website content, organizational data, custom-developed code subject to agreed intellectual property terms, administrative accounts, analytics accounts and hosting and backup accounts.

Third-party themes, plugins, fonts, stock images and other licensed components remain subject to their respective license terms. The developer must hand over required administrator credentials securely and must not retain undisclosed privileged access after the agreed handover.

26. TESTING AND QUALITY ASSURANCE

26.1 Functional Testing

- Navigation and buttons work correctly.
- Forms validate input and route submissions correctly.
- Email notifications function.
- Language switching works.
- Search operates correctly.

- Events display accurate dates and times.
- Authorized administrators can publish and update content.
- Unpublished content remains inaccessible to ordinary visitors.
- The website works on mobile and desktop devices.

26.2 Content Testing

- Correct institutional name and abbreviation
- Accurate organizational description
- Approved Objects and Mandate
- Consistent English and Chinese versions
- Correct contact information
- Correct event dates and project details
- Valid links
- Properly licensed imagery
- Accurate disclaimers and privacy notices
- No unsupported claims of government authority or endorsement

26.3 Security Testing

- Authentication and permissions
- Form protection
- File uploads
- Administrative access
- Data exposure risks
- Software updates
- Backup restoration
- Basic vulnerability checks

26.4 Accessibility Testing

Test keyboard access, focus indicators, form labels, color contrast, heading structure, alternative text and relevant screen-reader interactions.

26.5 User Acceptance Testing

SS-IETIB should nominate representatives to review the website before launch. The website must not go live until the organization has approved the principal design, core content, institutional wording, legal disclaimers and contact details.

27. MAINTENANCE AND SUPPORT

27.1 Maintenance Services

- Software updates
- Security patches
- Backup monitoring
- Restoration support
- Broken-link checks
- Performance monitoring
- Technical troubleshooting
- Form and notification testing
- CMS support

- Domain and hosting renewal reminders
- Security incident response
- Minor agreed content or design corrections

27.2 Service-Level Agreement

The plan should specify support hours, support channels, response times by severity, resolution targets, emergency contact arrangements, maintenance windows, service exclusions and additional charges.

27.3 Content Maintenance

SS-IETIB should appoint internal personnel responsible for publishing news, updating investment opportunities, maintaining directory records, updating events, reviewing research, monitoring inquiries, checking translations and periodically reviewing institutional and legal information.

28. ESTIMATED DEVELOPMENT TIMELINE

Stage	Indicative Duration
Requirements confirmation	1 week
Sitemap and content planning	1 week
Design and approval	1–2 weeks
Website development	2–4 weeks
Content preparation and translation	2–4 weeks, partly in parallel
Testing and revisions	1–2 weeks
Training and handover	1 week

Indicative Phase 1 duration: Approximately 6–10 weeks, depending on the availability of approved content, translation, design revisions and technical requirements.

The developer should provide a detailed schedule with milestones, dependencies and approval deadlines.

29. BUDGET AND COMMERCIAL PROPOSAL REQUIREMENTS

SS-IETIB should invite developers to submit a written proposal based on this specification. The proposal should separately price the following items:

Item	Required in Proposal
Discovery and requirements	Yes
UI/UX design	Yes
Website development	Yes
CMS setup	Yes
English content integration	Yes
Chinese translation and integration	Separate line item
Domain registration	Separate line item
Hosting	Separate line item

Item	Required in Proposal
Security configuration	Yes
SEO setup	Yes
Analytics setup	Yes
Testing and quality assurance	Yes
Administrator training	Yes
Documentation and handover	Yes
Maintenance and support	Separate line item
Phase 2 features	Separate quotation
Phase 3 features	Separate quotation

The developer must identify recurring fees, third-party licenses, renewal costs, transaction fees and dependencies on proprietary services. The proposal should also state the payment schedule, warranty period, support arrangements and intellectual property terms.

30. SUCCESS CRITERIA

1. A professional and credible website is publicly accessible.
2. The official name and institutional identity are accurately presented.
3. The website clearly explains the Bureau’s independent, private, non-governmental and non-profit status.
4. English and Simplified Chinese versions of agreed core pages are available.
5. The website works on modern mobile and desktop browsers.
6. All principal navigation links and forms function correctly.
7. Authorized staff can manage content through the CMS.
8. Security, backup and recovery arrangements are documented and tested.
9. Privacy notices and legal disclaimers are published.
10. Accessibility testing has been completed against the agreed benchmark.
11. The website is configured for search-engine indexing where appropriate.
12. SS-IETIB receives the agreed documentation, credentials and training.
13. Domain, hosting and administrative ownership arrangements are documented.
14. The website is ready for future expansion into a business and investment portal.

31. RESPONSIBILITIES OF SS-IETIB

SS-IETIB will be responsible for providing or approving:

- Official organization name
- Registration information required for accurate institutional presentation
- Approved Objects and Mandate
- Logo and brand assets
- Leadership information, where to be published
- Official contact details
- Approved English content
- Chinese translations or approval of supplied translations
- Approved photographs and other media

- Investment and business information authorized for publication
- Partner names and logos authorized for publication
- Legal and privacy content, with appropriate professional review
- Timely feedback and approvals

SS-IETIB should appoint a project coordinator authorized to communicate requirements, consolidate feedback and approve deliverables.

32. RESPONSIBILITIES OF THE DEVELOPER

The selected developer or agency will be responsible for:

- Reviewing the specification
- Identifying ambiguities and technical dependencies
- Proposing an appropriate technology stack
- Producing the design
- Developing the website
- Implementing the agreed functionality
- Integrating approved content
- Implementing language support
- Configuring security and backups
- Testing functionality and responsiveness
- Correcting defects identified during acceptance testing
- Training nominated staff
- Providing documentation
- Handing over credentials and agreed assets
- Providing post-launch support under the agreed contract

Any material change to the approved scope must be documented and approved before additional costs are incurred.

33. FINAL INSTITUTIONAL AND COMPLIANCE REQUIREMENTS

These requirements are mandatory throughout the project.

1. Identify SS-IETIB accurately as an independent, private, non-governmental and non-profit organization.
2. Avoid representing the Bureau as a government agency or statutory commission.
3. Avoid implying diplomatic, regulatory, licensing or public-authority powers.
4. Avoid implying government endorsement without authorization.
5. Publish only confirmed partnerships and properly attributed project information.
6. Distinguish between business facilitation and official government approval.
7. Avoid guarantees of investment returns or commercial success.
8. Protect confidential business and personal information.
9. Publish appropriate privacy, terms-of-use and disclaimer pages.
10. Respect applicable laws, intellectual property rights and data protection obligations.
11. Ensure public-facing information is accurate, appropriately sourced and regularly reviewed.
12. Clearly identify the source and limitations of investment and market information.
13. Maintain a process for correcting inaccurate information.

14. Ensure any future payment, membership, certification or verification features are accurately described and legally reviewed before implementation.

34. CONCLUSION

The proposed website will establish the South Sudan International Economic, Trade and Investment Bureau (SS-IETIB) as a professional digital platform for international trade promotion, investment opportunity facilitation, business networking, research and economic cooperation.

The initial website should prioritize institutional credibility, clear communication, accessibility, secure inquiry management and practical information for international businesses.

Future phases can expand the platform into the South Sudan International Economic Gateway, incorporating a structured business directory, investment opportunity database, event registration, business matchmaking and additional multilingual capabilities.

> The overall objective is to create a sustainable digital platform that connects South Sudanese enterprises and economic stakeholders with international markets while maintaining transparency, legal accuracy, responsible investment principles and respect for the Bureau’s independent non-governmental status.

Prepared for: South Sudan International Economic, Trade and Investment Bureau (SS-IETIB)
Document status: Draft for review and approval
Next step: Confirm the requirements, approve the scope and invite qualified website developers or agencies to submit technical and financial proposals.